

musician. In the same year as joining the Medicis, Francesca married Giovanni Battista Signorina, another court singer. The couple went on to have one child, Margherita, in 1622.

In 1618, the year of her father's death, she published *Il primo libro delle musiche* (The First Book of Madrigals), comprising 32 solo songs and four duets setting both sacred and secular texts. However, Caccini is most famous for being the first woman to write an opera: *La liberazione di Ruggiero dall'isola d'Alcina* (The Liberation of Ruggiero from Alcina's Island), which was published in 1625 and adapted from an episode in Ludovico Ariosto's epic poem *Orlando furioso* (1516), focuses on a struggle between two sorceresses—one good, one evil—over the warrior Ruggiero.



FLORENCE, c. 1650

This painting shows Florence as it would have looked in Caccini's day. It was here that the composer was born, grew up, and spent many years of her life.